



University Senate Minutes

September 17th, 2025
Melanie Grey Ceremonial Courtroom
4:00 – 5:30 pm

The chair opened the meeting by welcoming everyone in attendance to the first meeting of the 2025-26 academic year and for attending in-person. To officially begin the meeting, the chair stated, *"I acknowledge with respect the Onondaga Nation, firekeepers of the Haudenosaunee, the indigenous people on whose ancestral lands Syracuse University now stands."*

The chair introduced herself as Heather Coleman, associate professor in Biology and senator in the College of Arts and Sciences. She stated that it was a great privilege to be in the role as University Senate agenda chair. The chair shared that she had some very big shoes to fill following former chair, Senator Brice Nordquist and the chairs since she had become a senator, including Dr. Emily Stokes-Rees and Dr. Kira Reed. Dr. Coleman thanked the former chairs for setting the stage for how the University Senate currently operates. The chair hoped to continue the work of amplifying voices that are less heard and continue to increase engagement in these meetings.

The chair took a moment to thank Michael Morrison for his technical support, and Doreen Radin and Kim Kolpack from Caption Advantage for CART and captioning support. The chair thanked personnel from the College of Law, including Kristina Poletto for scheduling spaces the University Senate has used and Kyle Davis for technical support within the meeting. The chair also thanked Dean Terrence Lau for allowing the Senate to use the beautiful ceremonial courtroom.

The chair also thanked everyone in attendance for their willingness to serve as a senator or as a non-senator on committee, while acknowledging that there are many things that require people's time and energy and she appreciates that people are willing to show up to represent the governance process and represent our colleagues.

The chair also thanked the Chancellor for his leadership and service to the institution. She stated that she wasn't sure what factors lead someone to take on the role of Chancellor but she expressed her gratitude that there are people that do it and she expressed her gratitude to the Chancellor for the work he has done to promote Syracuse University and to build the university community over the last 12 years.

The chair noted the work of the previous Senate agenda chairs in their attempts to increase engagement in these meetings. She stated that we want to encourage more voices to participate in these meetings, both through engagement with the committee reports, but also

in the question and answer sessions. The chair reiterated that we want to make space for those who don't frequently speak up so the chair asked that we consider the posted ground rules. She noted that, as with last year, the ground rules will be posted in the chat on the beginning of each online Zoom meeting.

The chair read the ground rules to the membership to take time to reflect on them and to appreciate them and to hopefully encourage those who are less likely to speak out in these meetings to speak up.

- To create space for everyone to share.
- Allow equal participation.
- Everyone has a choice about when and when not to share.
- Use respectful language.
- Be respectful of each other and each other's ideas.
- Consider each other's perspectives.
- Don't interrupt.
- Keep comments short, focused and on point.
- Aiming for a maximum of a minute.
- If something has already been shared and needs to be reiterated, try to reframe it or to build on the previous points.
- All questions are legitimate.
- Receive comments with compassion and without judgment.
- Give people the benefit of the doubt.
- Don't make assumptions about intent.
- Be mindful of time for others to contribute.

The chair noted that while non-senators are not permitted to vote, non-senators are welcome to contribute to discussion. Non-senators can be permitted to speak by majority consent. The chair noted that the Senate's bylaws support this inclusion.

The chair reviewed the meeting agenda for the membership, noting that there would be two committee reports, remarks from the Chancellor and Provost, as well as unfinished business and new business, which would include a resolution circulated Monday, September 15th.

The chair thanked the Agenda Committee members, professors Christy Ashby, Kristin Barnes, Crystal Bartolovich, James Tapia, staff members Dan Cutler and Paula Possenti-Perez, student senator Reed Granger, Chancellor Syverud, Vice Chancellor and Provost, Lois Agnew. The chair stated that she was eager to work with the Agenda Committee members and she was looking forward to the year ahead.

The chair stated that as this was the first meeting and there were a number of new senators, as well as senators returning to the Senate after long absences, she wanted to review a few of the changes that have occurred over the past year while providing the Agenda Committee update.

Agenda Committee Report

The chair noted as a reminder, the Senate committees were restructured at the end of the 2023 24 academic year, such that there are now nine standing committees. The chair shared the list of current chairs of the committees. The chair thanked each of the people taking on the role as a committee chair or co-chair. She added that this is a very important leadership role and essential to the functioning of Senate and she expressed her gratitude for their

service. The chair noted that during the last academic year, the order of the agenda for meetings was rearranged, such that meetings start with committee reports and then we hear from the Chancellor and Provost later in the meeting. She stated that meetings will continue to follow this order this year, to foreground the work of the Senate committees and the important work that is occurring in our Senate. The chair noted that the amount of time dedicated to the Chancellor and Provost remarks, and the question and answer sections remain the same, but occurs later in the meeting.

The chair shared that the Agenda Committee was in the process of finalizing reporting templates, both written and presentation formats, to continue to encourage increased engagement within the Senate meetings. All committees are encouraged to identify a question or area for discussion to bring to the meeting and all Senate members are encouraged to engage meaningfully in these conversations as they arise.

The chair noted that the templates would be reviewed with the committee chairs at a meeting before the next full Senate meeting and provided to the committees as soon as they're finalized. The templates are written in such a way that they're structured to fulfill our structured reporting as well. The chair stated that assessment of the University Senate is an important part of the Middle States assessment and as many are hopefully aware, we are in the middle of a self study year. The templates remove the need for a separate assessment report from each committee.

The chair thanked the members of the Agenda Committee who worked to develop these templates over the last year, as well as Amanda Johnson Sangiuliano in the Office of Institutional Effectiveness and Assessment (IEA) for her support with this work.

The chair announced that in this academic year, the Senate would be making the switch to use Microsoft Teams as the main communication mechanism for the University Senate and Senate Committees. In the coming week, senators will receive notification of having been added to the Senate Teams group, as well as to the team associated with the committee on which they serve. The chair shared that the intent was to move towards having a centralized repository for all Senate related materials.

The chair went on to thank everyone who nominated faculty, staff, and students for the Chancellor search committee slate and for the slate put together by the Agenda Committee. The Agenda Committee was asked to do this on a very short timeline and the chair thanked everyone who contributed to the process.

The chair shared that the slate was approved by an overwhelming majority. The chair shared the list of nominees with the membership. The chair shared that the Senate would hear from the Parking Working Advisory Group which was formed in June. She added that the working group was formed based on the work of the Employee Services, Fiscal Affairs, & Operations (ESFAO) Committee, which will continue their work in this upcoming year.

The chair announced that an Ad Hoc Committee on Representation had also been formed. This ad hoc committee came out of work that was done by the Agenda Committee over the last year. The chair shared the members of the committee with the membership. The chair thanked the senator on the ad hoc committee for participating in this important committee.

The chair stated that in the coming month, the Agenda Committee would be working with the administration on the formation of a working group based on the recommendations of the Ad hoc Committee on Free Speech and University Policy from last year.

The chair concluded by noting that there were two standard orders of business to complete before beginning the committee reports

First, the chair moved on behalf of the Agenda Committee to approve the minutes from our April 16th Senate meeting. Due to technical issues, the chair called for a hand vote. The vote was taken and the motion was passed.

The chair noted that the second order of business relates to Article III, Section 6 of the bylaws which states senators may attend all regular or special meetings of the Senate. Persons eligible for membership in the Senate who are not elected senators may attend regular or special meetings of the Senate. Non-senators may participate in Senate deliberations only by majority consent. Non-senators will not be permitted to vote.

The chair noted that one non-senator had been appointed by their committee as co-chair. The chair stated that in order for this person to fully engage in Senate meetings without having to approve them in each meeting in which they wish to speak, the membership would now vote to allow the non-senator committee co-chair to participate for the full 2026-26 Senate term.

The chair moved to approve Rick DiRubbo, co-chair of the Committee on Curriculum & Instruction, to present and speak in Senate meetings during the 2025-26 Senate term. The chair called for a hand vote on the motion. The chair asked for all those in favor to raise their hands. The chair asked if anyone was opposed. The chair asked for any abstentions. The vote was taken and the motion was passed.

The chair reiterated that if non-senators want to participate, the meeting would have to pause and the Senate membership would take a vote to approve that participation. She added that in a Zoom meeting, we will ask that senators identify themselves again by putting "Senator" within their screen name.

For the in-person meeting, the chair asked for senators to hold their voting clicker up when they raise their hand to be recognized in an effort to help identify senators. The chair concluded her remarks and invited Rick DiRubbo to present the first report.

Committee on Curriculum & Instruction

Mr. DiRubbo thanked the chair and he introduced himself to the Senate as co-chair of the Committee on Curriculum and Instruction (SCCI). Mr. DiRubbo stated that the committee had a small report to consider and vote on. The committee's report included 10 course inactivations and two new subjects. He noted that the new subjects were the AEM-AI and Emerging Media subject and MDS- Media Studies subject.

Mr. DiRubbo moved on behalf of the Committee on Curriculum & Instruction to approve the September curriculum report in its entirety. A hand vote was taken. Mr. DiRubbo called for those in favor to raise their hands. He asked if there were any opposed. Mr. DiRubbo asked if there were any abstentions. The vote was taken and the motion was passed with one abstention.

Mr. DiRubbo noted that a big change for the year was that the University had moved away from its use of the curriculum management system, Curriculog. He noted that for those who work with and submit course proposals, this year would be a transition year. He noted that manual forms had been created to help manage the flow of curriculum work through the

schools and colleges, as well as the SCCI and Senate. Mr. DiRubbo asked that everyone working on curriculum be patient with the process and reach out for assistance if needed.

Mr. DiRubbo shared that besides completing curriculum reviews, since this committee did merge with the Instruction Committee, the SCCI has other items to work on throughout the year. He noted that last year the committee broke into subcommittees to deal with these other issues. He added that there would be three returning issues from last year. The committee would add any new items that came up during the year.

Mr. DiRubbo reviewed the committee's charge for the membership, noting that the main committee charge was to review the curriculum for the university. He noted that most of the work would be course and program proposals. He added that the members of the committee put in a great deal of work, noting that he personally felt that the committee is probably the hardest working of all the Senate committees. He also expressed his appreciation for the work of the manager of University Senate Affairs, Kelly Bogart, who manages and coordinates the workload of the committee. Mr. DiRubbo concluded his report by asking if there were any questions. As there were none, he thanked the chair and membership.

The chair thanked Mr. DiRubbo and invited Deirdre Joyce from the Parking Advisory Working Group to present.

Parking Advisory Working Group Report

Ms. Joyce thanked the chair and introduced herself to the membership, noting that she works in SU Libraries and she had been working as part of the Employee Services, Fiscal Affairs, & Operations (ESFAO) Committee's working group since last year. Ms. Joyce shared that she was one of the co-chairs of the Parking and Transportation Services Advisory Working Group, along with co-chair, Pete Sala.

Ms. Joyce shared that she wanted to provide an update regarding investigating some of the parking issues that have been identified. She shared that there had been some activity towards resolving some of these issues.

Ms. Joyce provided an overview of the formation of the advisory group, which was formed over the summer to engage with some of the familiar systemic parking issues that have challenged our campus for as long as many people can remember. Ms. Joyce stressed that the group was formed with the intent to work within a shared governance framework, and to provide periodic formal updates. She noted that the group would continue to do more informal regular reporting and collaboration with our stakeholders.

Ms. Joyce stated that she would be continuing to report and work with the ESFAO Committee and her co chair would maintain similar informal channels with the Chancellor's Office. She noted that while ESFAO was asked to provide a charge and plan of work, as a followup from previous conversations last spring, the Chancellor's Office followed up with a more formal charge for the committee roster to provide additional authority and responsibility for the group's work and that was received at the end of June.

The group is working on the following:

- An analysis of costs and affordability
- Access and accommodation for people with disabilities
- Better understanding of space availability and management
- A review of sustainability initiatives and policies

- An overall conversation on how parking and transportation is communicated and understood
- How well the various Feedback channels are actually working or not

Ms. Joyce shared that the original hope was that the group could start the discussion over the summer and be a substantial amount of the way through and have feedback by October. Ms. Joyce noted that the working group would likely miss that deadline by quite a bit. One of the first things that the group acknowledged was that this is really such a huge discussion and the group is dealing with a lot of historically complicated issues in an historically unpredictable time. Ms. Joyce indicated that the working group would likely need more time to grapple with everything.

Ms. Joyce acknowledged that in addition to the challenges of the big questions, the group had some logistical issues that delayed their progress, especially over the summer months. The group has moved into their own Teams environment to keep the discussion active and moving forward. The working group is also promoting asynchronous meetings and plan to have weekly rolling meetings. She noted that there are scheduled meetings on the calendar September through the end of December, which will be held almost weekly.

Ms. Joyce shared that the committee has good representation from administrative stakeholders and the Chancellor's Office helped identify individuals for the group. Additionally the group was able to include adjunct faculty as suggested by the Senate in the spring, including Senator Laurel Morton, who is not a formal designee on the committee, but who is working with Senator Nancy Keefe Rhodes to represent adjunct interests.

Ms. Joyce wanted to reassure everyone that the group was working. She noted that the working group could still use student representation. The group is also working towards getting representation from someone with an actual mobility disability.

Ms. Joyce acknowledged that while the working group had not made as much progress as it had hoped, the work continues and they would likely be looking to extend the original October deadline. She noted that the advisory group was put together to make recommendations around some of the large issues that have felt intractable for a long time. And while the group is not really ready to propose a scope and composition of a standing committee to deal with this on a permanent basis, the group have started to come to a consensus that this is probably where things are going to be headed. Ms. Joyce concluded her report by asking if there were any questions.

A senator asked if someone had to be a member of the ESFAO Committee in order to serve on the Parking and Transportation Advisory Group. Ms. Joyce responded that no, they didn't have to be a member of ESFAO.

Another senator wanted to share with the Senate that the original Senate Committee that proposed the formation of this committee included a senator with disabilities who is also the leading national expert on accessibility in higher education and there are also recommendations made by members of the disability community about the membership of this group, including a student who is a wheelchair user. While the senator appreciated the reference to making more additions to represent the disability community, but the committee itself started off with a member who fit both the professional expertise required by the committee, as well as the lived experience. From the perspective of the disability community, a person who works in, for example, in accommodations capacity is not necessarily viewed by the committee as someone who advocates on behalf of the disability community.

The senator offered to share with the working group resources that give some advice about disability representation and to connect the group with people who have mobility impairments as the discussion in the Senate committee was very fruitful and very much engaged with members of that community.

Ms. Joyce thanked the senator for recommendation and she expressed her appreciation for all the senator's contributions to the discussion so far.

Another senator shared their feeling of a distinct lack of a sense of urgency around this issue and it's quite frustrating. The senator noted that the campus community has been talking about this for a long time and the senator is hopeful that the committee will actually understand that this is affecting many people's daily lives and livelihoods and that these are issues that urgently need solving.

A senator asked about the process for nominating a student for the committee. Ms. Joyce responded that nominations could be emailed directly to her. She added that anyone with any feedback could email her at any time.

The chair thanked Ms. Joyce for her report and she invited Chancellor Syverud to give his remarks.

Chancellor's Remarks

Chancellor Syverud thanked the chair and welcomed everyone to a new year of University Senate. He noted that this would be his last "first" Senate meeting of the year as Chancellor. He shared that he had attended and taken questions at 95 full Senate meetings, as well as a large number of committee meetings. The Chancellor stated that he intended to continue doing so during his last year, with one notable exception. The Chancellor shared that he had recused himself from the Chancellor search process, which includes Senate discussions of the search, where appropriate. He noted that the Senate chair would alert him when it would be appropriate for him to step out.

Chancellor Syverud shared that he would provide brief updates on University finances, enrollment, and fundraising. He also planned to share some information regarding new leadership and shared governance, and the academic portfolio. He would conclude his remarks with a point of personal privilege.

Remembering Community Members

Before beginning his updates, the Chancellor wanted to remember three people that he knew well, and the Chancellor believed they should be recognized in the Senate.

First, iSchool Dean Emeritus Liz Liddy, devoted 44 years to Syracuse as a student, faculty member, dean, and interim provost. Dean Liddy was a wonderful teacher, a wonderful mentor, a scholar, and essential to the iSchool. Her life and contributions were to be honored at a Celebration of Life on Monday, September 29th, in Hendricks Chapel at 4:00 p.m.

Second, the Chancellor spoke of Professor Deborah Pellow, who he noted as a friend but, more importantly, Pellow was a passionate anthropologist and educator who spent 40 years on the faculty as a scholar and a teacher. The Chancellor shared that there was a beautiful memorial service in early September in Hendricks Chapel for Professor Pellow to celebrate her life and her career. The Chancellor thanked the many people who worked to make that

happen, including Senator Lori Brown, who was one of the leaders of that effort and who captured Professor Pellow accurately.

Finally, the Chancellor remembered Tiana Mangakahia, who was most well known for being a player on the women's basketball team. He noted that many people saw her play and her joy in playing. Mangakahia was a double alumnus. She earned her master's in sport venue and event management from the Falk College of Sport. She was a remarkable student, athlete, and person, and she passed away last week after a struggle with breast cancer that started while she was a student. The Chancellor asked that people please join him in keeping Liz, Deborah, Tiana, their family, friends, and everyone who knew and loved them in their thoughts.

Financial Update

Chancellor Syverud stated that many people are following closely the financial news coming from across higher education, and the news is grim. He shared that many of our peers were running serious deficits and were experiencing deep budget cuts and large-scale layoffs. He noted that this was not the story at SU, although it's not an entirely happy story at SU either.

The Chancellor stressed that it was important to understand that we are, for the moment, weathering the storms fairly well, even though some of schools, colleges, and units were facing more challenging circumstances than others, and more than usual. He noted that these challenges stemmed in part due to missed enrollment targets, shifts in discount rates, and other factors. The Chancellor stated that he recognized that some of our deans were navigating difficult financial realities. Chancellor Syverud stated that this underscored why we've been making, and are continuing to make, tough choices to shore up our financial position. He stated that we have to continue to take the necessary steps to insulate ourselves from whatever comes. The Chancellor shared that it was this kind of discipline that has so far left SU in a better position than many of our peers.

Chancellor Syverud shared the budget with the membership, noting that the University closed FY25 with a \$2.9 million surplus in its operating budget, noting that it was a very small percentage of our total budget, representing less than two-tenths of one percent. He shared that for FY26, we are projecting a balanced budget with a very small surplus of \$100,000 on a \$1.9 billion budget. The Chancellor pointed out that it was extremely difficult to get to a balanced result in FY25, and stressed that it would be more difficult to keep the budget balanced in FY26.

Chancellor Syverud shared that very, very few R-1 universities were running a genuinely balanced operating budget this year. He stated that he believed there was much more volatility in the budget than in previous years, and we must remain alert and nimble.

The Chancellor shared that our endowment grew by more than 9% last year, reaching \$2.266 billion as of July 31st, 2025. He noted that there was a great deal of concern regarding federal laws governing endowments, and particularly taxation of endowments. This was monitored very closely; however the so-called "Big Beautiful Bill" does not apply to Syracuse in this area as our endowment per student remains below the threshold.

In terms of fundraising for this past year, the Chancellor stated that it went well. Historically, Syracuse University's fundraising always drops dramatically once a campaign ends. Our campaign ended on December 31st, 2024. The Chancellor stated that it was very important given the challenges we're facing that this not happen this time. He noted that it hadn't

happened so far. He shared that we closed FY25 at 107% of our new business goals and 106% of our cashflow goals. He stated that we've been running well ahead of last year, and this year, noting that we're just one quarter into FY26.

The Chancellor stated that the fundraising and advancement team is focused on four bridge initiatives that will make sure we maintain our fundraising during this period between campaigns. They focus on financial aid, STEM, entrepreneurial leadership, and athletics. In particular, the financial aid initiative has been going well. Since April, the Syracuse Promise effort has already created 14 new endowed scholarships and made a dozen major gifts to existing scholarship funds.

Enrollment

In terms of enrollment: the Chancellor shared that for the fifth consecutive year, the University had record undergraduate applications, totaling 47,169. He noted that the Fall Census would be finalized later this month, but preliminary data shows our total enrollment is going to settle around 21,820 students this year. This included undergraduate, graduate, and professional enrollment. He added that it does not include the tens of thousands of students in non-degree programs at Syracuse. Our traditionally measured enrollment was falling by roughly 3.5% this year, which is driven largely by declines in international and master's enrollment.

The Chancellor stated that the overall undergraduate enrollment exceeded our goals. Law and doctoral enrollments are on track. He noted that our new undergraduate class included 3,945 undergraduates, which was 195 above goal. They are academically accomplished, with a 3.7 average GPA and mean SAT of 1351. He also noted that the percentage of international enrollment in the entering undergraduate class had decreased to 5%, which was at 12% two years ago.

The Chancellor noted that the decline in international students studying in the U.S. also impacted our master's enrollment. He stated that enrollment was roughly 41 students below goal in our master's enrollment, and this was largely due to international students, especially from China, had trouble getting visas in the United State, and this was not likely to change.

This fall the University welcomed 68 new full-time and 83 new part-time incredible faculty members. The Chancellor noted that Syracuse was fairly unique in welcoming a large class of incoming new faculty because of so many hiring freezes or slowdowns elsewhere. The Chancellor urged people to get to know the new faculty and their work.

Leadership

Chancellor Syverud shared that the Univesrity also welcomed Michael Bunker as our new Associate Vice President and Chief of Campus Safety and Emergency Management Services. The Chancellor noted that Bunker is a Coast Guard veteran with more than 20 years of leadership experience in public safety, most recently at the University of Denver.

The Chancellor announced that Chief Human Resources Officer, Andy Gordon, had moved into a new role as senior advisor to the Chancellor on priority strategic initiatives. The Chancellor expressed his gratitude to Mr. Gordon for his more than 10 years of service and for his outstanding work, particularly with the Senate to establish the Employee Benefits Advisory Council. The Chancellor stated that Alex Dietrich, a Navy veteran, who most recently served as associate vice president for talent strategy and human resources operations, is serving as interim Chief Human Resources Officer.

Chancellor Syverud noted information that had recently been shared with the community, which he wanted to reiterate to the Senate, specifically the recent decision regarding the role of Provost Lois Agnew. The Chancellor stated that he received a lot of thoughtful feedback from the community, and he concluded that it was in the University's best interest to remove the word "interim" from Lois Agnew's title and to extend her service as provost through December 2026, or at most June 2027, at the discretion of his successor. The Chancellor noted that this would allow the next chancellor to participate in the selection of a long-term provost in the coming year.

The Chancellor noted that the feedback was overwhelmingly supportive of this course of action. He shared that he received a great deal of feedback regarding Lois' outstanding leadership, character, and effectiveness, as well as the importance of continuity at this time. He noted that some had raised valid concerns about precedent and process. The Chancellor stressed that this was an exceptional circumstance, which was tied directly to the timing of his own transition. He noted that the next provost search will fully follow our shared governance practices. In the meantime, the Chancellor stated that he was confident that Lois would continue to guide our academic mission with the integrity and dedication she has demonstrated so far. The Chancellor congratulated Lois Agnew on this change.

Shared Governance

Chancellor Syverud shared that he always talks about shared governance at the first Senate meeting of the year because there are new senators, people who haven't experienced shared governance, and fewer people who come to this university from elsewhere have experienced shared governance. He stated that he had answered a lot of tough questions from the University Senate over the past 12 years. He expressed his gratitude for people asking them, for probing, for challenging, for not accepting the status quo, and for being an active participant in shared governance, which shows that people care about the University.

The Chancellor urged everyone to approach our work this year with the assumption that each of us is acting in good faith and trying to make the University better. He noted that it has been a brutal year for shared governance at schools in the United States, and that warns us that leadership at Syracuse means that we need to make it visibly work to show it can work. He noted that even discussion of disagreements is healthy, and marks a healthy institution.

Chancellor Syverud shared updates on three shared governance topics that came out of the Senate last year in which the Chancellor was involved in or advised about: these are parking, free speech, and academic affairs.

In terms of parking, the Chancellor recalled the report that was given directly before his remarks. The Chancellor thanked Deirdre Joyce for her report. The Chancellor stated that he believed he had followed the counsel of the Senate in helping to set up and charge the working group and giving it authority. The Chancellor thanked Deirdre Joyce, Pete Sala, and the whole group on their first report, and their willingness to work on these issues. He noted that he was looking forward to receiving a report and recommendations. The Chancellor stated that his one worry was, as with many issues in the Senate, how long it takes for things to be resolved. He noted that while all parking issues may be interrelated, it would be okay to break down some of them and make recommendations along the way. He noted that his ability to implement recommendations has a timeline.

Regarding free speech, the Chancellor stated that he received a report of the Ad Hoc Committee on Free Speech and he understands the committee's plans to provide further

recommendations this year. The Chancellor expressed his gratitude for the committee's commitment to advancing free speech on campus, and he appreciated the Senate's advisory role in this. He stated that he would carefully consider any recommendations as the University makes policy decisions around free expression, while noting that these issues have his full attention and concern right now.

The Chancellor addressed the current environment we're living in. He shared that since October 2023, when the world changed in dramatic ways, our approach at the university had been to try and make sure that we meet the following three necessary conditions for Syracuse University to thrive:

- First, maintain safety for all our students and all our community, with an emphasis on all.
- Second, as an institution, we have to comply with the law, and that includes Title VI, the First Amendment, and due process.
- And third, we must uphold the longstanding values of this institution, which go back more than a century. These have remained our values even as the world and law changes.

The Chancellor noted that it has become more difficult since October 2023 to meet all three of these conditions. Chancellor Syverud acknowledged that many people have made sacrifices to determine the right steps to keep the University safe and consistent with our values. The Chancellor stated that he was acutely aware of how hard it's been for each of us, and he didn't think it was going to get easier.

Chancellor Syverud shared that ethical judgment calls come up a lot. He noted that he tries to make them in the interest of the whole University, and not according to anyone's party line and not based on his own personal interests. He stated that he'd tried to do this over the past 12 years, and it's certainly what he intends to do as long as he served as chancellor.

The Chancellor shared that he had recently attended a meeting of the Senate Academic Affairs Committee. During that meeting, the Chancellor was asked questions about academic budgets, portfolio review, the honors program, diversity and inclusion, and the Chancellor search. The Chancellor thanked co- chairs and Senators Matt Huber and Peggy Thompson for including him in their meeting. The Chancellor encouraged the committee to keep focused on the academic freedom and free speech issues.

In terms of Portfolio Review, the Chancellor wanted to provide a little context, noting that Provost Agnew would be speaking more about the topic in her remarks. He noted that higher education faces federal funding disruptions, lawsuits, and declining international enrollment, while new challenges are also emerging. Chancellor Syverud stated that at many peer institutions, the responses have been rushed and reactive. He stated that at Syracuse, we have the chance to be proactive and deliberate. He stated that Syracuse is financially stable today, but we cannot be complacent about that.

The Chancellor stated that one purpose of the Academic Portfolio Review was to strengthen high-quality, high-demand programs and take a hard look at those that may be falling short. Our people are best positioned to guide these choices. The Chancellor encouraged students, faculty, and staff to be active participants in the process, including at the school and college level.

Finally, the Chancellor concluded his remarks with a point of personal privilege. He noted that many people have reached out in recent weeks. He expressed his appreciation for the support and words of encouragement. He shared that he'd been asked about choosing to finish up this year. To this query, the Chancellor responded that he has served two full five-year terms and a two-year extension, and after fulfilling those commitments and one additional semester in the spring, the Chancellor felt the time was right to conclude his tenure in this role.

Chancellor Syverud shared that he loves Syracuse University. He stated that he believed the University was in reasonably good shape to select and recruit a new chancellor. The Chancellor stated that while he'll no longer be chancellor, after a sabbatical, he was very excited to continue teaching courses here, as he'd been doing every semester since he was announced as chancellor 12 years ago.

The Chancellor stated that for the rest of this year, we still have a lot to accomplish, noting that this would be an important year for Syracuse University. The Board of Trustees will lead the process to select our next leader, while we still navigate everything going on in higher education. Chancellor Syverud encouraged everyone to participate in the Board's search process.

The Chancellor thanked everyone for their involvement in shared governance, and for their ongoing commitment to our university, to the students, and to our future. The Chancellor stated that he looked forward to working with everyone in his final year stewarding this great university. Chancellor Syverud thanked everyone in attendance.

The chair thanked Chancellor Syverud for his remarks. She noted that the Provost was not able to attend the meeting in person, but the Provost would provide her remarks virtually. The chair invited Provost Lois Agnew to give her remarks.

Provost's Remarks

Provost Agnew thanked the chair and began her remarks by joining Chancellor Syverud in welcoming everyone to a new academic year. Provost Agnew noted that it had certainly been a busy September. Provost Agnew apologized that she couldn't attend in person due to illness.

Provost Agnew stated that she would spend much of her time on the academic portfolio review efforts under way, and would provide brief updates on other Academic Affairs priorities including the Middle States reaccreditation process, and the review and interim leadership of the Renee Crown Honors Program.

Provost Agnew referenced the announcement at the beginning of the semester that she had asked the deans to conduct a portfolio review process over the course of the next year. She noted that since 2017, we have reviewed individual programs on a four-year cycle, but this was the first time in many years that we are looking holistically at our entire academic portfolio. The Provost noted that this review comes at a critical moment. We are in the midst of a rapidly changing landscape in higher education.

The Provost noted that questions from students and parents about the value of a college degree, sharp declines in international enrollments, and economic uncertainty have created significant challenges for private institutions in the last enrollment cycle. The Provost reiterated that we are financially stable today due to the determined efforts of many people, but the path we are on is not sustainable if we continue without change.

She stated that students want to know what makes a Syracuse education distinctive and we need to be sure we can answer that question with confidence. The Provost noted that one challenge we face in building distinctive efforts is an academic portfolio so vast our resources are spread too thin.

The Provost reported that we have 402 degree granting programs. The average for institutions our size is 235. She stated that this means that we have tried to support more programs than we can afford and we have not adequately invested in programs that have high demand. Provost Agnew shared that the purpose of the review was certainly not to diminish our academic profile but to sharpen it, to ensure that we are aligning resources with programs that are academically excellent, mission centered, and sustainable for the long term.

Provost Agnew stated that the deans have been supplied with extensive data, including nine year enrollment data and financial metrics, to guide their conversations with faculty over the next year. We intend for this to be a collaborative process that balances quantitative evidence with qualitative metrics about our programs contributions to our mission of education, research, and service.

Provost Agnew stated that the goals are to identify and elevate areas of preeminence, invest in innovative programs with strong potential, to support service courses that play a vital role in our curriculum, and to work thoughtfully with faculty on programs where sustainability is in question, whether that leads to reenvisioning, rebranding, consolidation, pause in new enrollments, or in some cases, closure.

The Provost shared that deans have made preliminary recommendations for pausing or reenvisioning programs and are working with faculty and other leaders in the colleges to determine next steps. This work is about ensuring that Syracuse University continues to thrive, not only today, but for the students we'll serve in 2030 and beyond.

Provost Agnew stated that, as previously announced, we have initiated a review of the Renee Crown Honors Program. The Provost noted that Honors plays a vital role in attracting and retaining high achieving students and academic research for Syracuse. The Honors Program has been one of the most valuable resources for many years. The Provost stated that over the past decade, the University has considered changes that might enhance Honors, including those recommended in a 2016 external review of the program.

Provost Agnew stated that last year, Dean Mortazavi convened a committee chaired by Professor of Music and Honors Core faculty member, Peppie Calvar. The Provost stated that the committee conducted a thorough review of the program and offered recommendations for curricula revision suggested in the 2016 external review and further attention to assessment of key outcomes such as experiential learning.

The Provost stated that the committee also noted that curricular revisions should support the goals of building an Honors program that serves excellent students across the entire university, which, at this point, is a goal that is imperfectly realized. The committee also strongly recommended the development of strategies to increase faculty investment in the program and its curriculum, and to expand faculty roles to schools and colleges beyond Arts and Sciences and Maxwell.

Provost Agnew thanked Dean Mortazavi for his leadership and moving this conversation forward and she expressed particular appreciation to Professor Calvar and the other committee members for their work on an excellent report.

Provost Agnew stated that based on the committee's recommendations, she has convened the Honors Working Group with membership from faculty across schools and colleges. The Provost stated that the working group would be co-chaired by Vice Provost Jamie Winders and Associate Provost Eliza Dekaney, a long time member of the honors corps faculty.

The Provost shared that she had charged the group with reviewing the Honors Program curriculum, including a thesis requirement, proposing a governance structure for the Honors Program, including bylaws, charter or charge, mission statement, governing and advisory body, and suggesting strategies to create more faculty engagement and involvement with the Honors Program. The group's report is expected later in the fall semester. Provost Agnew also thanked Laura Machia, Associate Dean for Academic Initiatives and Curriculum of the College of Arts and Sciences for stepping in as interim director during this time of transition. The Provost stated that Machia's leadership will ensure continuity as we await the working group's recommendations.

Provost Agnew reminded the Senate membership that the University was now in the process of seeking Middle States reaccreditation through an institutional self study. The Provost noted that this is an important process and our success will be contingent in part on engagement from all members of the campus community. The process kicked off last semester with a visit from Middle States liaison Tiffany Lee and the completion of the self study design, which has been approved.

Provost Agnew shared that a steering committee and working groups composed of 140 faculty, staff, and students from across the University had been formed. These working groups are convening this semester to evaluate the large amount of evidence required to demonstrate that we are meeting the seven accreditation standards outlined by Middle States.

The Provost offered thanks to the Office of Institutional Effectiveness and Assessment (IEA) for compiling the evidence from units across campus and to all units who engage in annual assessment. The Provost noted that draft reports from each working group are due by the end of the semester. A year from now, a copy of the self study will be released for internal review and open comment. A site visit and final decision from Middle States will happen in spring 2027. The Provost remarked that this is a big undertaking.

Provost Agnew thanked Julie Hasenwinkel and Katie McDonald, who are co-chairing the steering committee and the self study, as well as all members of the working groups and steering committee.

The Provost concluded her remarks with some brief announcements. Provost Agnew stated that she was proud to report that 2025 has been a strong year for National Science Foundation (NSF) proposal funding with \$19.7 million total in awards. That's an increase of \$5.8 million over last year. Additionally, NSF has recognized four of our early career faculty with prestigious NSF career awards including Assistant Professor Xiaoran Hu from Chemistry, Assistant Professor Bryan Kim from Electrical Engineering, Assistant Professor Georgia Mansell from Physics and Associate Professor Baobao Zhang from the Maxwell School, Politics of AI.

The Provost stated that these honors not only underscore the exceptional quality and innovativeness of the professors' research but remind us how critical early career success is for attracting and retaining top scholars and strengthening research excellence at our university. As we move forward, Vice President for Research Duncan Brown and his team will continue supporting faculty through grant development and resources, and strategic guidance to ensure we maintain this momentum and expand our impact nationally and globally.

The Provost thanked the chair and the membership and offered to take questions. The chair thanked the Chancellor and Provost, and asked if there were any questions.

Q&A

A senator from the Department of Communications and Rhetorical Studies in the College of Visual and Performing Arts. The senator wanted to ask about academic freedom and free speech in the wake of the recent assassination of Charlie Kirk, and the response to it from many corners, including the Vice President's call for retribution by outing people and attempting to get them fired. There have been many cases of that nationally as well as the Attorney General's enlightening distinction between free speech and hate speech.

The senator asked the Chancellor and Provost to reaffirm for the Senate, their commitments to academic freedom and freedom of speech, which should be a rhetorical question that is unnecessary to ask, but there are reasons that people are unsettled. The senator noted the renaming of the Office of People and Culture as an example, among other over the past 12 years. The senator ended their comments by expressing their appreciation for the eloquent voice of justice and DEI that is our former colleague, Professor Jen Jackson.

Chancellor Syverud responded that it's been a long 12 years, and there have been a lot of times where free speech and academic freedom issues have called upon us to take a position at some personal cost, and that seems to be the fate we have now as well. The Chancellor stated that right now we are in a situation where a human being was murdered in front of hundreds of college students, many of whom agreed with his views, and the reaction has been complicated and troubling.

The Chancellor noted that there are arising from this, serious security concerns about college campuses because of the response that has been on social media directed at faculty members. The Chancellor added that there has been concern that faculty members, as professionals, have not responded humanely to the event, including to the family and have been interpreted or portrayed as condoning or encouraging violence against people with certain views, certain views that some of our students might hold.

Chancellor Syverud noted that some of our students might be in our classes, so the challenge is figuring out what to do in response to that, to defend all our students and defend the academic and free speech rights of all our faculty. The Chancellor acknowledged that it has been a tough set of judgment calls and we're continuing to manage it. The Chancellor reiterated that we have to manage it and take into account safety and Title VI.

The Chancellor added that we have to consider a long history of free speech and academic freedom that is incorporated in both the Syracuse Statement and in the Faculty Manual at Syracuse University, which protects academic freedom and free speech, but which also has professional responsibilities for faculty members to think hard about the impact of what they say and how they say it, on their students. The Chancellor stated that we are going to keep walking that line to keep the campus safe and to uphold the values that you describe.

The Chancellor indicated that he could say more about diversity and inclusion and the decisions that were made with Mary Grace Almandrez over the summer, but the most important thing is the current situation with free speech and academic freedom, and the need to work on it together, including the processes in the Senate.

Provost Agnew responded that this certainly has been on our minds, especially following the Charlie Kirk assassination, and all kinds of other events. She stated that certainly the University unequivocally supports academic freedom, which is focused on research and teaching, and also freedom of speech. The Provost reiterated the Chancellor's response, that the Faculty Manual does urge faculty members to think about their special position in the community when they speak as citizens.

The Provost added that there are particular guidelines in terms of considering how they need to position themselves in terms of exercising restraint, showing respect for the opinions of others, and making sure that they're not speaking for the institution. Those are broad guidelines and we have to work through together exactly what that means. Provost Agnew stated that Associate Provost Jamie Winders was planning to convene some conversations with faculty members so that we can talk about what freedom of speech means for faculty members and what it means in a world that is increasingly complicated by the circulation of speech on social media.

The Provost suggested that if anyone has ideas about that effort and our effort to be proactive in creating more opportunities to think through this together, people should reach out to Associate Provost Winders. She added that everyone's participation in helping us think about this are welcome.

Another senator stated that for many years, faculty and administration have worked together amicably and fruitfully on the IDEA requirement for the Liberal Arts Core and shared competencies. The senator noted that we have all considered these curricular matters and that's why we have been working together on them for so many years. The senator stated that when faculty returned to campus for the fall semester, we found that over the summer, the IDEA requirement language and meaning were changed, as well as were some of the shared competencies, and as far as the senator knew, there was no faculty participation in any of those changes.

The senator restated that they believe the changes were curricular in nature because even though none of the courses that satisfy the IDEA requirement have been changed, nonetheless, the IDEA requirement helps define the content of dozens, if not hundreds of courses at the University, and the shared competencies describe and define the skills that we are required to impart or we hope to impart, to our students in every single course on this campus, so if there is a claim that they're not curricular, the senator does not find that persuasive at all.

The senator acknowledged that there are many faculty members who would support these changes; certainly under the dire circumstances in which we teach right now. The attacks on the University, the fact that higher education did not unify and build a united front against these changes so that each university and school now has to fend for itself, maybe there is support for these changes. I would imagine there would be quite a bit but the haven't been consulted.

The senator continued, stating that we see what is going on around the country at Texas A&M and other schools where political pressure is being placed on administrators and faculty members are getting fired for teaching their courses, particularly gender and transgender courses at Texas A&M as a case in point. The dangers are great when shared governance, faculty governance prerogatives over curriculum are not recognized. We need to work together. The senator made a strong appeal to the Provost to find a way to consult with faculty

over these changes, maybe by bringing these changes to the Senate Committee on Curriculum & Instruction or finding other ways to have a real conversation with faculty over these changes. The senator hoped that the Provost would consider that.

Provost Agnew thanked the senator for their remarks. She responded that these concerns have been brought to her attention, and she stated that she's certainly committed to working with faculty on many different issues and will continue to do that. Provost Agnew stated in the case of these changes, first of all, the description in the catalog of the requirement is not the curriculum and it's not the outcomes under which courses for the curriculum are measured.

The Provost added that language was not approved by the Senate as far as we have been able to determine. The requirement itself was approved by the Senate, but not the particular language about the requirement. And the courses in the curriculum were not changed, as the senator noted. The criteria by which courses are eligible to be in that curriculum have not changed.

That being said, Provost Agnew also shared that one thing that has concerned her since she moved into the Provost's Office, even as Associate Provost, is that the Senate has not had a formal role since approving the requirement and determining what courses are in that category. That determination has been made on the basis of three readers at a time, appointed by the Associate Provost for Academic Programs and based on the judgment of those readers, courses can go into the curriculum or not.

Provost Agnew also noted that those courses have not been assessed and if the course is proposed for the requirement by one person and someone else starts teaching it and they don't teach it in the same way, there is no way to make the determination that the course does or does not continue to fulfill the idea requirement.

The Provost shared that she has asked the Curriculum & Instruction Committee to appoint a subcommittee who can look at this requirement and figure out what we can do to make it more effective and to continue working together to make sure that the requirement fulfills its initial goals.

With respect to the language of the shared competencies, the Provost responded that it's correct that we removed the diversity and inclusion reference in the ethics and integrity shared competency requirement. The Provost stated that the shared competencies are not a curriculum. There are curricular and co-curricular elements that contribute to that. The Provost stated that the courses approved in that requirement were still present, so there has not been a change there.

Provost Agnew stated that one of the issues with the shared competencies is they were created in response to a Middle States recommendation and we use the Middle States criteria in developing the categories with the ad hoc committee coming up with the precise titles in those categories. At the time those categories were developed, Middle States was requiring that institutions provide evidence about diversity and inclusion.

They have since notified us that they're no longer requiring institutions to provide evidence in that category, and so it's appropriate that we remove the category as we prepare for our Middle States review and the evidence that we will provide of the shared competency categories.

Another senator asked Provost Agnew a question about the process of portfolio review, where there will be qualitative and quantitative review, and how we are going to avoid slippage, especially when, as the Provost and Chancellor noted, while we are in good financial shape now, we can't count on that if there is a financial threat, which is implicitly quantitative and involves quantitative measures like getting people in seats.

The senator noted that there is a quantitative pressure and the senator wondered how we keep the qualitative salient in our assessments in the face of the compelling nature that is always there for quantitative assessments particularly when they are linked to the pressures of finances.

Provost Agnew thanked the senator for their question and responded that these issues had been on her mind quite a lot over the last few months, and her answer is by working together, by taking this process seriously and working together. The Provost shared that some people have asked why are we doing this now, and why don't we just wait. The University is apparently not in terribly financial shape, so let's just wait. The Provost shared that the reason she wants us move forward with this process now is that we have the opportunity to work together and really think about those questions, of how we can come up with informed decisions that are not driven by panic.

Provost Agnew stated that a lot of institutions have waited until they're in a terrible situation and then they're just rapidly closing a whole bunch of programs without actually taking a look and figuring out, collectively, what the best approach is. We are not doing that. We are trying to look at the data, at the numbers, which are important, while also trying to engage people in thinking carefully about where there is middle ground between doing everything exactly the way we have done it for many years and having a viable and sustainable academic curriculum.

The Provost shared that we wouldn't be going through all of this, if our plan were just to keep the programs that have the highest enrollments and cut everything else. We can continue to have some programs that are not as successful, not drawing as many students. We just can't have as many of those. We need to figure out where our priorities lie, where we can invest and be willing to be creative about finding alternatives. She noted that some departments, including the senator's own department, that have stepped up and figured out a way to revitalize a humanities discipline.

In speaking of the English department, the Provost noted that the department has always had a good major that has had a good number of students. But those numbers have increased significantly with the creation of the creative writing major. The department found an area that students are really interested in and that is really bringing great visibility to the department.

The Provost suggested that if everyone would be willing to engage in this in good faith and working together, we can bring the qualitative and quantitative together in a way that other institutions haven't, and that's her hope.

The chair thanked everyone for their comments and questions. She stated that the agenda needed to move on as there are two additional agenda items. The chair reminded everyone that the meeting was scheduled to end at 5:30, noting that people have other draws on their time. The chair noted that old business would be very short as there was no old business to bring forth. The chair then invited Senator Crystal Bartolovich to bring forth her new business.

New Business

Senator Bartolovich thanked the chair and introduced herself to the membership. She introduced herself as a member of the Agenda Committee, as well as President of the American Association of University Professors (AAUP). Senator Bartolovich noted that the resolution to be put before the membership came out of questions and concerns that came to AAUP regarding the portfolio review process.

Senator Bartolovich stated that those putting forth the resolution wanted to be sure that the primacy of faculty control over the curriculum was going to be foregrounded. Senator Bartolovich shared that things became more complicated because in one college, department chairs went to a chairs' meeting expecting to give the preliminary reports on the portfolio review.

Senator Bartolovich stated that in this meeting, the chairs learned that decisions had already been made with no input from them or any other faculty regarding which programs and department majors in that college were going to be paused. That has real material effects and no faculty were consulted, and the chairs learned about this at this meeting.

That is an example of process that is not happening the correct way. Senator Bartolovich stated that she hoped everyone could agree about that. And this resolution is attempting to affirm that we can do better than that.

Senator Bartolovich stated that the faculty having primary control over the curriculum is not some outmoded tradition. It is there because faculty expertise is actually what underwrites the integrity of the academic program. So when the faculty are not consulted about important changes, it actually calls into question the integrity of the academic program itself.

Senator Bartolovich stated that every faculty member she had spoken to was as deeply concerned for the health of this institution and wanting us to have the best possible programs and this is also true of departments that are struggling; so that these decisions were made above us without our input is deeply troubling.

Senator Bartolovich called upon the membership to please consider voting for the resolution, and affirming the Senate's strong commitment to faculty having primary control over the curriculum and that no major changes should occur without the input of the faculty.

Resolution in Support of Faculty Control over the Curriculum in "Portfolio Review"

Whereas the principles of faculty governance as described by the AAUP state that, barring financial exigency, "the decision to discontinue formally a program or department of instruction will be based essentially upon educational considerations, as determined primarily by the faculty as a whole or an appropriate committee thereof.";

Whereas financial exigency as described by the AAUP does not exist at Syracuse University and in fact our situation has been reported to be one of financial stability;

Whereas the principles of the AAUP are integrated into the Faculty Manual and thus are the basis from which our shared governance procedures are established;

Whereas the faculty have already been actively involved in continuous program review of all academic programs and issued ongoing recommendations to administrators in ways that are appropriate to a model of shared governance in relation to program structure;

Whereas university-wide review of the academic program as a whole is desirable, but a hasty review that evades the regular curricular process is not;

Whereas the modification or elimination of programs are de facto curricular decisions;

Whereas effectively unilateral administrative decision-making about the curriculum that does not follow established procedures for curriculum review is contrary to models of shared governance and undermines the integrity of the curriculum over which the faculty have primary responsibility;

Be it resolved that the Syracuse University Senate affirms the primary control of the faculty over the curriculum and proposes that changes to the academic structure of the university, especially program elimination, go through the usual review process at the college level and then be forwarded to the Senate Curriculum Committee for a Senate vote before being enacted.

The chair asked if there were any questions for Senator Bartolovich

A senator thanked Senator Bartolovich, and asked to make a friendly recommendation that the resolution be a little more specific. The senator stated that as a former chair of the curriculum committee, there are a number of things that do not come through the curriculum committee, even though faculty are over curriculum. The senator offered as example classes that are going to be discontinued and programs that are going to be closed, as well as shared competencies review.

The senator recalled that Provost Agnew mentioned previously that the IDEA courses were done by a smaller number of people. The senator suggested that it's always been in our bylaws that faculty have control over the curriculum, but suggested that the resolution was talking about broader issues than how we are currently defining curriculum. So the portfolio review does not seem to be against what we are already doing. The senator asked if there was something specific that the resolution was trying to say.

Senator Bartolovich responded that the resolution was specifically stating that the elimination of programs should be coming through the Senate, and should be coming through the Curriculum & Instruction Committee. Senator Bartolovich noted that the discussion has taken place before when discussing the Liberal Arts Core and how core would not have to have a Senate vote because of the weirdnesses of those determinations. Whether that's a good idea or not, though, is a different issue.

Senator Bartolovich continued, stating that the affirming by this body of the intention for the administration to work in the spirit, as much as possible, of shared governance over the curriculum, so that a roomful of chairs are not shocked by getting information about decisions already made after having done a great deal of work.

Provost Agnew asked to comment on the resolution and the previous senator's remarks. First the Provost wanted to clarify that she never suggested that the faculty's control of the curriculum was an outmoded idea. The Provost stated that she didn't know that there was anyone in administrative roles who would say that. The Provost reiterated that she strongly encouraged the faculty to participate in this process, and we are working very hard to make sure that happens.

The Provost recalled the previous senator's comments, noting that the resolution states that program closures will go through the usual process and be forwarded to the curriculum committee and to the Senate for vote before being enacted and that is not the current process.

The chair called attention to the time, and as it was 5:30, the chair suggested that the resolution be tabled until the next meeting.

Senator Harvey Teres moved to extend the meeting 15 minutes to continue the current discussion. The motion was seconded. The chair called for a vote on the motion to extend the meeting. The motion passed to extend the meeting to continue the discussion, with one objection and three abstentions.

A senator asked for clarification regarding the usual review process and the definition of pausing a program. The senator asked if a pause applied only to majors and not to minors, and does it mean that students can't enroll in the major.

Provost Agnew responded that a pause is a temporary measure that gives us time to work on deciding what comes next. The programs that have been recommended for closure are those programs where people in the programs have already signed off on closure or there are no students or they have just not been closed for logistical reasons.

Those programs that have been paused are programs in which we are not recruiting through the enrollment process new students to come to campus with the expectations that they would major in those departments or in those programs. This is a one year temporary measure that gives us time to take stock and figure out what to do to make sure that if we enroll new students in those programs, we are ready to be sure that they will be successful and sustainable during the four years the students would be here, but it is not a closure and it's not a final decision. It's signaling that we are taking stock.

A senator asked for a list of the programs being referred to.

Senator Bartolovich stated that there were three programs that were only getting rid of their BA program and keeping their BS program. Senator Bartolovich read the list of programs that were to be paused.

African American Studies; Classical Civilization; Classics; Digital Humanities; Fine Arts; French Francophone Studies; German Language, Literature, and Culture; History of Architecture; Italian Language, Literature, and Cultural Studies; Latino-Latin American Studies; Middle Eastern Studies; Modern Jewish Studies; Music History and Cultures; Religion; and Russian Language, Literature, and Culture.

A senator asked for clarification if program pauses and closures do not go through the curriculum committee, who does approve them and specifically who approved these changes that these chairs were apparently presented with as a done deal.

Provost Agnew responded that typically program closures go through Academic Affairs by memo, and then New York State is notified that this has been done. It usually comes through the department to the college and then to Academic Affairs. She stated that she believed the dean's office made the recommendation about pauses, but again, this is not a done deal. This is a category for further conversation.

Another senator, carrying over from previous comments, noted the section regarding going through the usual review process at the college level. The senator noted that there is likely

variability there and the senator noted from their our own college, that the college curriculum committee does not vote on program elimination. The senator stated that there are other mechanisms to get faculty input and to have conversations about the implications but it's not a voting situation. The senator stated that they were a little concerned that the resolution is not precise enough in terms of what it is calling for, even if we agree with the spirit. The senator was not sure that the resolution was asking for the right mechanisms.

Another senator had a question for Provost Agnew regarding her remarks where there would be discussion and review of programs that were outlined and a process for that which would take place collaboratively across the year, and then it seems now that we just learned this has already been done. The senator noted that it seems that the process has already started and it sounds like it is already finished. The senator wondered if the Provost could clarify her original remarks about what is intended for the process to look like across this academic year.

Provost Agnew responded that in her remarks she said the deans have made preliminary recommendations and now we are going through the process of consulting with faculty and figuring out a way forward as we look at each program. People are characterizing pauses as a done deal. This is not a done deal.

The Provost stated that this is not recruiting new students, which, on an annual basis for the programs that are paused, is a very small number of students. So, they're not recruiting new students until we determine what our next steps are, what these programs look like, and which programs we have decided collectively we want to invest in.

Provost Agnew stated that there is much more conversation to take place. The presentation to the chairs, as she understood it, was about preliminary categories that programs have been placed in with the hope that there will be many additional conversations about the direction we'll take in making final decisions about these programs, as well as other programs that might benefit from various types of changes as we continue working to create a more dynamic and focused curriculum.

A senator asked Provost Agnew if the program pause is a one-year pause and a one year pause only.

Provost Agnew responded that she believed that the pauses were a one year pause that will give us time to figure out at the end of the year what is the decision about the program, and again, it could be to revise, it could be to close, it could be to merge with other programs. There are a lot of different directions we could take. And again, the Provost thinks what everyone needs to understand is this review has been based on nine years of data that shows very low enrollments and declining enrollments.

She added that for the well being of the programs, and the students in the programs, it's important to find a way forward so that students have the best academic experience and we are able to show students as best we can, what should encourage them and motivate them to come to Syracuse, and the answer to that is always distinctive and excellent programs.

The senator asked a second question, asking what is the function of the pause. The senator asked why we can't just do the process of assessment and do we need the pause. The senator asked if it was because it's costing us enormous amounts of money to run the programs or to enroll students in the University to pursue these majors.

Provost Agnew responded that the reasons for the pause are if we have majors that have very low enrollments or no enrollments, and we have one student who decides to come to Syracuse and decides to declare that major, it will be a difficult situation for us and the student if we find ourselves with a whole major with one student in it.

We feel that it's very important that if we are not absolutely sure of the long term sustainability of the program, to let students who are looking at Syracuse now, understand that if that program continues to be offered, students can find their way to it. If the program continues to be offered, the next year we will have a stronger message about its viability, and hope we will be able to ensure that we have a major that is not only two or three students who are making their way through the major together.

Senator Bartolovich thanked the Provost for her comments. She then noted that the discussion had reached the limits of its 15 minute meeting extension. Senator Bartolovich proposed that the discussion be tabled and postpone the rest of this discussion and vote to the next meeting when it will have a designated place on the agenda.

The motion to table until the October Senate meeting was seconded. The vote was taken and the motion to table was passed. At the conclusion of the vote, the chair reminded the membership that the reception would take place directly after the meeting in the Dineen foyer.

A senator asked to be recognized to ask a question regarding the deliberate mechanisms the Agenda Committee instituted to safeguard and secure the representation of members of historically marginalized communities in the nominee list have you forwarded or shared with us today.. The Senate chair noted that there was a vote on the floor of the Senate that needed to be completed and no new business can be raised until the vote has been completed. The chair noted that the extension to the meeting had passed and the meeting had been called, The chair indicated that they would answer the senator's question in the next meeting.

The vote to postpone the discussion until the October meeting was taken. The motion was approved.

The chair moved to adjourn the meeting. The vote was taken and the meeting was adjourned at 5:47 pm.

Attendees

Abok, Jane
Albring, Susan
Almandrez, Mary Grace
Almeyda, Melissa
Arnold, Phil
Ashby, Christy
Barnes, Kristen
Benedict, Joshua
Bhan, Mona
Bowman, Nicholas
Brown, Harriet
Brown, Lori
Bryant, Joan
Bulman, Gail
Cáliz Casanova, Ana
Campbell, Kelly
Cass, Peter
Catalino, Karrie
Chandler-Olcott, Kelly
Chapman, Gabrielle
Chernobai, Anna
Clarke, Rachel
Coleman, Heather (Ch)
Combs, Michele
Costello-Staniec, Andria
Cutler, Dan
DaSilva, Tommy
Dekaney, Elisa
DeLoach McCutcheon,
Kendra
Dharwadkar, Ravi
Diem, Albrecht
Dima, Vlad
DiPietro, PJ
Dismuke, Vanessa
Dixon, Sheriah
Dunham, Chris
Dohne, Deborah
Ebner, Michael
Eiffe, Chris
Endeladze, Qeti
Erdman, Maria
Eversole, Britt
Fathers, James
Fisher, Gareth
Fleckenstein, Jan
Fonger, Nicole

Gaines, Heather
Giannini, Stefano
Giles, Patty
Glazman-Schillinger, Ian
Goenka, Tula
Gomez, Luis
Graham, Mary
Granger, Reed
Grifasi, Karly
Grimes, Diane
Hagenloh, Paul
Hallas, Roger
Harter, Don
Heckman, Denise
Hepburn, Adam
Huber, Matt
Ivanov, Ivan Gitsov
Jiang, Hua
Kallander, Amy
Kallander,, George
Kantrowitz, Rebecca
Kehoe, Gabrielle
Kinsey, Dennis
Klaver, Coran
Kornfilt, Jaklin
Kutcher, Norman
Lachut, Max
Leach, Alexis
Leonard, Kincaid
Leuschke, Graham
Lewis, Kate
Liu, Xiyuan
London, Andrew
Lopez, Gretchen
L'Pree, Charisse
Macfarlane, Kat
Martinez, Armando
McCoy, Amy
McGee, Jordan
McKnight, Lee
Miller, Cameron
Mirer, Anna
Mitchell, Michelle
Mitra, Devashish
Morris, Charles
Morton, Laurel
Mulvaney, Matthew

Nangia, Shikha
Newton, Cathryn
Nordquist, Brice
Oh, David
Ojo, David
Pak, Ricky
Peter, Pam
Possenti-Perz, Paula
Raina, Ramesh
Reed, Kira
Rhodes, Nancy Keefe
Robinson, Briell
Rojos Betanzos, Ruben
Roland-Silverstein,
Kathleen
Rosa, Richard
Russo, Natalie
Saluti, Andrew
Sanders, Shane
Schell, Eileen
Schimpff, Tracey
Sharma Paudel, Basanta
Smith, Cole
Soltani, Amin
Starr, Bijan
Stokes-Rees, Emily
Straub, Beck
Strony, Jera
Terez, Harvey
Terrell, Robert
Thompson, Margaret
Tochelli, Erin
Todorova, Svetla
Toenniessen, Ray
Tryloff, Hunter
Van der Meer, Matthieu
Van Gulick, Robert
Van Slyke, David
Westlund, Haley
White, Julia
Williams, Ryan C.
Winders, Jamie
Yung, Doug
Zadzilka, Joyce